

Real or Fake?



BIG IDEA Pictures, voices and chatbots can be made by computers, and some look or sound very real. Clues help, and the safest habit is: Source, Sense, Second look.

1 HOOK 2'	2 ACTIVITY 8'	3 DISCUSS 3'	4 TAKEAWAY 2'
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PREP IN 5 MINUTES

Materials: Picture Cards (R-8.1), Voice Cards (R-8.2), Chat Cards (R-8.3), Real / Fake / Can't Tell paddles or thumbs. No AI tools are used.

- Make paddles, or practice thumbs: up, down, sideways.
- Pick two picture, two voice and two chat cards.
- Write the 3 S's on the board: Source, Sense, Second look.

1 HOOK 2 MIN *60-second script* “Priya’s grandma got a call. It sounded exactly like Priya’s cousin. ‘I’m in trouble, please send money fast and don’t tell anyone!’ Grandma almost sent it. But she remembered what Priya taught her: pause and check. She hung up and called her cousin on the number she knew. He was at home, safe. A computer had copied his voice from a video online. Computers can make things that seem real: pictures, voices, even chat ‘friends.’ You do not have to be a computer expert. You just need three little checks: Source, Sense, Second look.”

2 ACTIVITY 8 MIN *Three-Station Whole-Class Detective*

- (3 min) Pictures.** Show two Picture Cards. Real, fake or can't tell? Reveal. What clue helped? (Source: who posted it? Second look: does a trusted source show the same thing?)
- (2 min) Voices.** Read two Voice Cards aloud (the urgent family call, a friendly teacher). Apply the 3 S's. Family rule: hang up, call back on a known number, ask for the code word.
- (3 min) Chatbots.** Read the card that says, “I’m your best friend! Don’t tell your parents about our chats.” Real friend or program? Then a helpful card: chatbots are useful when we remember what they are.

3 DISCUSS 3 MIN

- “If a computer can copy a voice, how can a family stay safe?” (Callback and code word.)
- “Why not share private feelings or secrets with a chatbot?”
- “Is it okay to say ‘I can’t tell?’” (Yes! It is a smart answer.)

4 TAKEAWAY 2 MIN “When a picture, voice or chat feels odd, hackles up! Being fooled is never your fault. Source, Sense, Second look. If you can’t tell, ask a grown-up. A chatbot is a program, not a person.”

Hand signal: Hackles Up, Pause palm, Check fingers, Tell hand on chest. Whisper, then say strongly: “I can’t tell, I’m asking a grown-up.”

EXIT TICKET “Write one of the 3 S’s and a question you would ask.”

FUN BOOST Paddle Pop (30 seconds). Rapid-fire silly statements (“A cat wrote this homework!”). Show Real, Fake or Can’t Tell in 3 seconds. Can’t Tell is a winning answer.

LEVEL-UP Chatbot Facts for Little Kids. Write three kid-friendly facts about chatbots for a younger class.

DIFFERENTIATE Use picture cards with large drawings and thumbs instead of writing; reduce to two voice cards.

FAMILY CARD Chatbots are programs, not people, and can be wrong. Invite your child to tell you if any online “friend,” picture or voice made them uncomfortable.

IF A STUDENT TELLS YOU SOMETHING

Say: “Thank you for telling me. You did the right thing.” “This is not your fault, and you are not in trouble.” “I can’t keep this a secret, because I need to get you help. I will tell you who I tell.”	Do not say: “I promise I won’t tell anyone.” “Are you sure?” or “Why didn’t you tell me sooner?” - Anything beyond “Can you tell me more?”	First 10 Minutes: see the Disclosure Guide. Then: tell your counselor or designated person right away. Follow your school policy and your state’s reporting law.
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